

Internship Reflection

DEVOPS INTERNSHIP • BEACHWARE

Initial expectations

Before beginning my DevOps internship at Beachware, I expected the experience to be mainly technical. I thought I would spend most of my time working independently on cloud systems, deployment tasks and networking problems while applying the concepts I had learned at university. I also expected the workplace to be more structured than university projects, with clear tasks and established procedures for completing them. My main goal was to improve my technical skills and gain a better understanding of how software and infrastructure are managed in a professional environment.

Professional experience and communication

The reality was broader than I expected. Technical work was important, but communication, teamwork and adaptability were equally important. During the internship I worked on cloud deployment and infrastructure automation tasks, assisted with server-related operations, resolved more than 20 networking issues, and collaborated with vendors and technical team members. I was also involved in discussions about CI/CD pipeline products and communicated suggestions to senior staff. This showed me that engineering work is rarely completed in isolation. Even when a problem is highly technical, solving it effectively often depends on communicating clearly with other engineers, vendors and stakeholders.

Technical problem-solving and professional accountability

The most important lesson I learned was the value of systematic problem solving. When dealing with networking or deployment issues, it was important to identify the problem, gather the relevant information, test possible causes and document the outcome rather than immediately changing the system. I also learned the importance of professional accountability. In a live technical environment, small mistakes can affect other users or systems, so changes need to be considered carefully and communicated to the appropriate people. These lessons were important because they changed the way I approach engineering problems and made me more aware of the responsibility involved in technical work.

Value proposition

My value proposition to an employer is that I combine software and mechatronics engineering knowledge with practical experience in software development, embedded systems, infrastructure and team leadership. I can demonstrate this through my Beachware internship, my work in UTS Rocketry, and my role as Founder and CEO of Vaylo Technologies. At Vaylo I have helped develop and deploy a business platform using technologies including React, Node.js and Supabase while coordinating technical development across a team. These experiences demonstrate that I can learn new technologies, work across different engineering areas and take ownership of delivering practical outcomes.

Career development

The internship also influenced the type of role I am interested in pursuing. It confirmed that I enjoy roles where software interacts with real systems and where I can work across development, infrastructure, networking and embedded technology. I am particularly interested in software, mechatronics and systems engineering roles that involve solving complex technical problems as part of a multidisciplinary team. Rather than focusing only on one narrow area of engineering, I want to continue developing as an engineer who can understand both the software and the wider system it operates within.
